

DigiPick of the month

1 GB—Lest I forget!



Last month's winner:

Sankalp khanna

Amritsar.

Participate and
win next month:

**Beginning
Access 2007
VBA**

by Denise Gosnell



Published by

WILEY-INDIA

WIN!

Send in your entry and you could win an exciting gift by sharing an amusing picture with a tech angle to it. The picture should have been shot by you, and should not have been published anywhere earlier.

E-mail your picture with "**DigiPick**" in the subject line, mentioning your postal address, **on or before the 20th of this month** to digipick@thinkdigit.com. One prize-winning picture will be published each month.

play games. And bachelors with a history of failed relationships (and who aren't getting laid anytime soon). Right? Well, think again. Turns out even "responsible" couples with babies (!) can behave like spoilt teens when it comes to games.

This is from Reno, Nevada (where else could this happen but in the US?). A couple, Michael and Iana Straw, were fanatic gamers. They spent most of their time online, playing games like *Dungeons and Dragons*. The immersive environment of these massively multiplayer games was too immersive for them. So they forgot they had two babies. They played and played, the babies (must have) bawled and bawled, and the couple played and played, and you get the idea, that no food went into the babies' mouths. When social workers turned up to check on the kids, they found them sick and severely malnourished.

The Straws had clearly crossed the fine line that separates passion from madness.

They didn't have steady jobs, but the mister had \$50,000 as inheritance. And no prizes for guessing what he did with it: splurged it on computers and a large-screen plasma TV, ostensibly to improve the gaming experience (!)

The couple have pleaded guilty to charges of child neglect, and will face trial. The babies, meanwhile, are in foster care and doing well. (Umm, virtual Columbine killers later on in life, perhaps?)

MYSTERIOUS MISCHIEF

Defending The Asses

If you were looking to (cough) download some movies from the (cough) Internet and innocently visit www.P2P.net, it will redirect you to www.TorrentFreak.com, a well-known BitTorrent news site. So what's the deal? Time for a little history lesson, and we'll try hard not to bore you. (Read: "Please Read.")

A company called MediaDefender, paying

filthy amounts of \$\$\$, bought P2P.net. This company happens to have been hired by the likes of the Recording Industry Ass. of America (the ill-famed RIAA) and the Motion Picture Ass. of America (the equally ill-famed MPAA) to find and report people who use BitTorrent and P2P to download copyrighted content. (Read: "People who download.") In the past, MediaDefender has resorted to launching fake video uploading sites, and setting up fake torrent trackers that record and log user's IP addresses. MediaDefender also regularly uploads fake torrent sites on popular BitTorrent sites to collect details of the happy-go-lucky folks who download the torrent files. Such conduct has enraged the P2P community (Read: "The people"), with site admins offering to help each other remove the MediaDefender menace from their sites.

Against the backdrop of this tense scenario, when P2P.net was launched, someone did a WHOIS on the domain name and found "MediaDefender."

People Who Changed Computing

The Face Behind The Screen



James Fergason

LCD monitors are pretty, and it's been a long, long journey from the time of the LCD displays in

watches and such. Thank James Fergason, the man who improved the LCD and kicked off the now-multi-billion-dollar LCD market.

Fergason did not discover liquid crystals; what he did discover was how to use them the correct way. Prior to his work, LCDs used too much power, had limited life, and poor visual contrast.

Born to a middle-class American family, he attended a one-room school. He grew up reading science books and admiring his brothers who had degrees in engineering. His grandfather was a child prodigy who graduated at age 15. With such role models around him, Fergason decided that he should invent something...

Graduating from Missouri University in 1956 with a degree in physics, he joined Westinghouse Research Laboratories. There he studied liquid crystals—his passion—and thought up the first practical way to use them. The first commercial use of LCDs came in quartz watches. Fergason went on to create his own company to manufacture displays.

The man's latest invention includes safety eyewear whose liquid crystals become opaque instantly when hit by intense radiation like lasers, thus protecting the eyes.

He received the Lemelson-MIT Prize, considered the "Oscar for Inventors." Now who'd think liquid crystals were something to be passionate about?